

THURSDAY

FOCUS ON: Jesus

READ TOGETHER: Matthew 6:25-34

ANCHORED BY PRIORITIES

But seek first the kingdom of God and His righteousness, and all these things shall be added to you. (Matthew 6:33)

FOR FAMILY WORSHIP: Pages 36-38

FURTHER STUDY FOR PARENTS: Pages 39-41

WHO LEADS THE PARADE?

The hillside is awake. Morning light spills over Galilee, the grass bends in the wind, and the crowd leans closer to Jesus. Parents hold children. Workers rub tired hands. Teenagers listen from the edges. Grandparents stand quietly. Hidden inside people are invisible backpacks of worry: What will we eat? What will we wear? What will happen tomorrow?

Then birds sweep across the sky, and Jesus points upward. He gives one sentence that can reorder a whole life: “But seek first the kingdom of God and His righteousness, and all these things shall be added to you” (Matthew 6:33). Jesus does not say, “Run faster,” or “Carry everything alone.” He says, “Seek first.” Put God at the center. Let His kingdom be the first voice, the first direction, and the first light in the room.

In a **VUCA WORLD**, plans can change quickly, tomorrow can feel unclear, calendars become

crowded, and voices can sound important at the same time. A notification says, “Look at me.” A worry says, “Fix me now.” A trend says, “Follow me.” A screen says, “Just one more swipe.” But Jesus asks, before the noise chooses for us: What belongs first in our hearts today?

Think of the day like a parade. School, work, meals, chores, games, screens, rest, and play are marching. But every parade needs someone to lead it. If the loudest thing runs to the front, everyone gets mixed up. When God leads, everything finds its right place.

That is how we learn to manage priorities. We choose what matters most before the loudest thing grabs our attention. It is not about doing more until we are tired. It is about putting first things first, so our time and screens do not boss our hearts around.

Today, let’s ask Jesus to help our family begin with Him, follow His peace, and let His kingdom lead our home.

READ

ASK

FAMILY PRAYER

Line up by the door, hold hands and pray: **“Lord, lead our day like a parade. Help every choice follow You first. In Jesus’ name, amen.”**

Like now, back in Jesus' times, life was like:

VOLATILE: Life felt unsafe and shaky.

UNCERTAIN: Families worried about tomorrow.

COMPLEX: Many worries filled their hearts.

AMBIGUOUS: What should come first?

But today, with God's help, we can turn it into:

VENTURE: Follow Jesus when life shakes.

UNVEIL: Find what matters most.

COMPASS: Let God guide our choices.

ASSURANCE: Protect love in our home.

Jesus did not remove every worry, but He taught us what to place first. In a **VUCA WORLD**, priorities help us follow God's order, protect what matters most, and live with a calmer heart.

1 Read
Matthew 6:33
together

2 Underline
the word
"**first**"

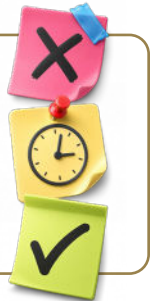
3 Ask yourself:

- What do I choose first each morning?
- Does my time show what I value?

Jesus teaches us to put God and love first, so noise and screens do not run our home. I promise to help our family protect time for God, rest, and each other, **because you matter more than anything urgent.**

FAMILY ACTIVITY: Traffic Light Home Map

Use red, yellow, and green crayons or sticky notes. Walk through your home together. Mark green where screens rest, yellow where screens need limits, and red where screens stay out. **Then ask: "Where can our family make more room for God, rest, and one another?"** Display the map this week.



**FURTHER STUDY
FOR PARENTS:**

ANCHORED BY PRIORITIES

Today's Principle:
Priority Management

Today's promise for your home is calm and ordered:
When God comes first, your family can breathe.

This parent section helps you see priorities as a spiritual practice: choosing God before pressure, love before alerts, and rest before rush. You will learn how home spaces, daily rhythms, and screen boundaries can quietly teach what matters most.

V VENTURE BEYOND FEAR IN A VOLATILE WORLD

Parents know the feeling of a crowded day. Breakfast, work, school, bills, messages, errands, and worries can all shout at once. In that noise, the question is not only, "What must I do?" but "What should lead my heart and my home?"

Jesus does not answer anxiety by asking parents to do more. He gives a better order: "Seek first the kingdom of God and His righteousness" (Matthew 6:33). Priority management means choosing what comes first before pressure chooses for us. It is like putting the biggest rock in the jar first; then the smaller things can find their place.

For a home, this means God shapes the calendar, the phone, the table, bedtime, and how we respond to stress. Concerns will still come. But peace begins when the home is not led by fear, urgency, or screens, but by God's order.

WHAT YOU PUT FIRST QUIETLY TEACHES YOUR FAMILY WHAT MATTERS MOST EVERY SINGLE DAY.

U UNVEIL DEEPER TRUTH IN UNCERTAIN TIMES

Read Matthew 6:33 quietly and underline the word “first.” Then pause before the day begins and ask: What do I reach for first? What gets my attention before God or my family? Does my time show what I truly value? Does technology organize my day, or do I organize it?

Jesus shows that anxiety grows when our priorities are out of order. When every message, task, and worry feels urgent, the heart forgets what matters most.

MANAGING PRIORITIES IS MORE THAN PLANNING THE DAY. IT IS LETTING GOD PLACE LOVE, WORSHIP, AND FAMILY IN THEIR PROPER PLACE.

C COMPASS THAT REMAINS STEADY THROUGH COMPLEXITY

Priority management means helping your family place the most important things first. It is not about making a perfect schedule or adding one more burden to an already full day. It is about asking, “What do we love most, and how can our home protect it?”

Jesus gives the order clearly: “But seek first the kingdom of God and His righteousness” (Matthew 6:33). First does not mean we ignore work, school, laundry, meals, messages, or tired children. First means God’s kingdom becomes the compass that helps us decide what deserves our best attention.

Educational principles from the writings of Ellen White remind parents that the home itself teaches. She wrote, ***“It is in the home that the education of the child is to begin. Here is his first school”*** (Ellen G. White, *Child Guidance*, p. 17). That means children are learning from the rhythm of the house: what is protected, what is interrupted, what is repeated, and what is allowed to lead.

Technology can quietly change the order. A notification can become louder than a child’s story. A quick scroll can replace a bedtime prayer. The urgent can push away the essential. This is why priority management is not only about screen time. It is about what screen time may be replacing.

A wise family does not need to live with fear or shame. Parents can begin with small, hopeful choices: a screen-free table, a peaceful bedtime, a protected worship moment, a family conversation without phones, or a charging place outside the bedroom. These visible decisions tell children, “This matters to us.” “You matter to us.” Clear boundaries are not cold walls. They are loving fences around faith, rest, connection, and peace.

WHAT YOUR FAMILY PUTS FIRST TODAY BECOMES THE MEMORY YOUR CHILDREN CARRY TOMORROW WITH GOD’S HELP.

A ASSURANCE THAT STANDS FIRM AMID AMBIGUITY

This week, parents can do a simple activity called the **LOVE-REST-GOD HOME CHECK**. Sit together for ten minutes after the children are asleep, with paper and three colors. Instead of walking through the house with the children, talk about your family rhythm. Mark green for moments that must stay screen-free, such as worship, meals, and bedtime. Mark yellow for screen use that needs a clear purpose and time limit. Mark red for habits you both agree will not enter the home, especially phones in bedrooms at night.

Then choose a shared charging place, a daily disconnection time, and a protected family connection time. This is not punishment; it is shaping the home.

ASK: WHAT ARE WE PROTECTING FIRST?



ANCHORED BY PRIORITIES

Is my home shaped for distraction or connection? Jesus reordered the heart. In a **VUCA WORLD**, peace grows when God comes first. Screens are not the enemy; disordered priorities are.